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STUDENT DISCIPLINE

The Edmond Public Schools Board of Education believes that the school's primary goal is to provide a safe learning environment for all members of the school community. This policy and corresponding regulations define standards of conduct to which students are expected to conform and provide options for the methods of control and discipline of students as required by law. In order to comply with the board's statutory obligation to notify all students, teachers, and parents of the adoption of policies for the control and discipline of children attending school in this district, the substance of this policy and regulations shall be available through the student handbook and the district website.

No teacher or administrator will administer formal discipline to his or her own child on behalf of the school except in cases of disruption in the classroom or common areas. Disciplinary matters concerning children of school employees will be handled by the appropriate principal or the superintendent or the superintendent's designee. The superintendent's child will be disciplined by someone other than the superintendent.

A) Each student shall be treated in a fair and equitable manner. Disciplinary action will be based on a careful assessment of the circumstances surrounding each infraction. The following are some examples of these circumstances:

1) The seriousness of the offense;
2) The effect of the offense on other students;
3) Whether the offense is physically or mentally injurious to other people;
4) Whether the incident is isolated or habitual behavior;
5) The manifestation of a disability;
6) Any other circumstances which may be appropriately considered.

B) Standards of behavior for all members of society are generally a matter of common sense. The following examples of behavior are not acceptable in society generally, and in a school environment, particularly. The involvement of a student in the kind of behavior listed below will generally require remedial or corrective action. These examples are not intended to be exhaustive, and the exclusion or omission of unacceptable behavior is not an endorsement or acceptance of such behavior. When, in the judgment of a teacher or administrator, a student is involved or has been involved in unacceptable behavior, appropriate remedial or corrective action will be taken.

The following are examples of unacceptable behavior:

1) Academic Dishonesty
2) Arson
3) Assault (physical and/or verbal)
4) Conduct that threatens or jeopardizes the safety of others
5) Disruption of the educational process or operation of the school
6) Distributing obscene literature
7) Dress Code Violations

8) False reports or false calls
9) Fighting
10) Forgery
11) Gang-related activity or action
12) Harassment, Intimidation, and/or Bullying
13) Hazing
14) Hitting/pushing/tripping
15) Inappropriate language, gestures, pictures, videos, or behavior
16) Indecent exposure
17) Leaving school without permission
18) Misuse of an electronic device
19) Physical altercation causing injury
20) Possessing, using, or sharing alcoholic beverages or other mood-altering chemicals as outlined in the Drug Free Schools Policy, FNCF
21) Possession of gun-related instrumentalities (bullets, shells, gunpowder, pellets)
22) Possession of weapons or other items with the potential to cause harm
23) Possession, threat, or use of a dangerous weapon, including, but not limited to, firearms, knives, facsimile of a gun, or other dangerous devices as outlined in the Weapons-Free School Policy, FNCGA
24) Racial discrimination including racial slurs or other demeaning remarks concerning another person's race, ancestry, or country of origin, and directed toward another student, an employee, or a visitor. This includes antisemitism, which is a certain perception of Jews, which may be expressed as hatred towards Jews.
25) Refusing detention or assigned consequence
26) Sexual Harassment
27) Theft
28) Threatening behavior (whether involving written, verbal, or physical actions)
29) Truancy
30) Unexcused lateness to school or to class (tardies), and/or cutting class
31) Use or possession of tobacco in any form, including cigarettes, vapes, vapor devices, and E-cigarettes, as outlined in the Tobacco Policy, CKDA
32) Vandalism
33) Willful disobedience of any directive of a school official, violation of the board of education policies, rules, or regulations, or violation of school rules and regulations.

In addition, conduct occurring outside of the normal school day or off school property that has a direct and immediate negative effect on the discipline or educational process or effectiveness of the school will also result in disciplinary action, which may include in-school placement options or out-of-school suspension.

C) In administering discipline, consideration will be given to alternative methods of punishment to ensure that the most effective discipline is administered in each case. In all disciplinary actions, teachers and administrators will be mindful that they are dealing with individual personalities. The faculty may consider consultation with parents to determine the most effective disciplinary measure.

D) In considering alternatives for corrective actions, the faculty/administration of the school district will consider those listed below. However, the school is not limited to these alternative methods, nor does this list reflect an order or sequence of events to follow in disciplinary actions. The board of education will rely upon the judgment and discretion of the administrator to determine the appropriate remedial or corrective action in each instance.

1) Conference with student
2) Conference with parents
3) In-school suspension
4) Detention
5) Referral to counselor
6) Behavioral contract
7) Changing student's seat assignment or class assignment
8) Requiring a student to make financial restitution for damaged property
9) Requiring a student to clean or straighten items or facilities damaged by the student's behavior
10) Restriction of privileges
11) Involvement of local authorities
12) Referring a student to the appropriate social agency
13) Suspension
14) Other appropriate disciplinary action as required and as indicated by the circumstances, which may include, but is not limited to, removal from eligibility to participate or attend extracurricular activities as well as removal from the privilege of attending or participating in the graduation ceremony, school dances, prom, prom activities, and/or class trips.

Parents, guardians, and students enrolled in this school district shall be notified at the beginning of each school year that this policy is in effect. A copy of this policy will be made available upon request to parents or guardians at any time during the school year.

Parents, guardians, and students residing in this school district are also advised by means of this policy statement and by the student handbook that students in this district shall have no reasonable expectation of privacy rights towards school officials, in school lockers, desks, or other school property. School personnel shall have access to school lockers, desks, and other school property at any time, and no reason shall be necessary for such search. Student property may be searched with reasonable suspicion.

Teachers, parents, guardians, and students are invited and encouraged to participate in the formulation of disciplinary policies, rules, and regulations by suggesting to administrators appropriate means of discipline for specific infractions.

REFERENCE: 10 O.S. §7115, 70 o.s. §6-114, 70 o.s. §24-101.3

THIS POLICY REQUIRED BY LAW.